

— DAD'S CODE · A LIFESTYLE RESET



THE 90-DAY REBUILT DAD

Get your energy, your body and your momentum back — one simple day at a time.

Dad's Code by Jamie Wigg · *Present, not perfect.*

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What's **inside**

One whole-life reset. Three 30-day phases. A handful of simple daily habits, and a printable tracker so you never have to rely on willpower alone.

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I rebuilt myself at 48. You can start today.

For years I was the tired one. Overweight, anxious, knackered before lunch — dragging myself through the day and snapping at the people I loved most.

I told myself it was just age. Just being a busy dad. But deep down I knew where that road went, because I'd watched my mum walk it. I loved her, and I lost her too early. Standing there, I made a quiet promise: I wasn't going to hand my kids the same story.

So at 48, I started. Not with a gym membership I'd never use or a diet I'd quit by Friday — with **a single walk around the block**. Then another. I sorted my sleep. I drank some water. I caught the morning light. I talked to myself a bit kinder.

None of it was dramatic. All of it added up. I lost a lot of weight, the fog lifted, and now I run every day — something the old me would have laughed at. I'm not special, and I'm not finished. I'm just a dad who decided to stop waiting for the right moment and use this one.

This guide is the reset I wish someone had handed me. Ninety days, three phases, a few honest habits. Not a meal plan — your food's covered elsewhere — but the **whole-life rebuild**: how you move, sleep, think and keep going. It's achievable, it's honest, and you can start it today.

— *Jamie. Present, not perfect.*

⚠ READ THIS FIRST

This guide is general information only — not medical, health or fitness advice, and not a substitute for care from a qualified professional.

! **Talk to your doctor before you change your exercise or lifestyle** — especially if you have a medical condition, take medication, are recovering from illness or have had surgery, or simply haven't been active in a long time.

! Start gently and build slowly. **Stop and seek medical help** if you feel chest pain, dizziness, breathlessness beyond normal exertion, or any pain that isn't right. Pushing through warning signs is not toughness.

! Everything here is **general and non-prescriptive**. It is not a personalised plan and sets no targets for any individual. Your care team's advice always overrides anything in this book.

! If anything here conflicts with professional advice you've been given, **ignore this guide and follow the professional**.

! This reset is about feeling well and showing up for your people — not punishment. Go at your own pace.

HOW IT WORKS

YOU DON'T NEED TO OVERHAUL YOUR
LIFE. YOU JUST **DON'T BREAK THE CHAIN**
— ONE SMALL, HONEST DAY AT A TIME,
FOR 90 DAYS.

Ninety days is long enough to change how you feel and short enough to see the end. Three phases, each building on the last: **Foundations** (lay the base), **Momentum** (let it roll), **Identity** (become the bloke who just does this). Same handful of habits all the way through — you simply get steadier at them. (See *Read This First before you start moving.*)

Days 1–30 • Foundations

Lay the base. We're not chasing results yet — we're proving to yourself that you turn up.

1–30
PHASE 1

Foundations

FOCUS: SHOW UP, KEEP IT TINY

● ○ ○ PHASE 1 OF 3

Month one is about one thing: becoming a man who keeps small promises to himself again. Forget intensity. Forget the scales. If the habit feels too easy, you've got it exactly right — easy is what survives a bad day. These four habits are the whole job for the next 30 days.



A daily walk

Ten minutes outside, every day. Round the block, to the shop, after dinner. Movement is the keystone — start here. (*See safety note.*)



A fixed bedtime

Pick a lights-out time and protect it. Sleep is where your energy actually gets rebuilt.



A glass of water first

One big glass before your morning coffee. Easy win, every single day, no thinking required.



Tick the box

Mark it off on your tracker. The tick is the point — you're building proof, not perfection.

Move-safe note: Before adding the daily walk, check Read This First. If walking is new for you, keep it flat and gentle, and clear it with your doctor — especially after any illness, injury or surgery.

Days 31–60 • Momentum

Let it roll. The base is laid — now we nudge it forward and let the wins start stacking.

31–60

PHASE 2

Momentum

FOCUS: BUILD ON THE BASE, STACK THE WINS

● ● ○ PHASE 2 OF 3

By now the habits don't feel quite so heavy. This month you keep everything from Phase 1 and gently turn up the dial. You'll start to feel it — clearer mornings, a lighter step, a bit more patience with the kids. That feeling is the fuel. Add these on top of your Foundations.

↪ **Carry forward:** walk • bedtime • water • tick the box



Stretch the walk

Push your daily walk toward 20–30 minutes, or add a small hill. Move a little more, not a lot more. (See *safety note*.)



Morning light

Get outside within an hour of waking. Daylight first thing sets your body clock and steadies your energy and sleep.



Wind-down hour

Screens down 60 minutes before bed. Protect the sleep you fixed in Phase 1 so it actually pays off.



One kind line

When the old self-talk shows up, swap it: "I'm a dad who's rebuilding." Notice the win, however small.

Move-safe note: Increase distance, time or hills slowly and only as it feels comfortable. Breathlessness should be mild — if it isn't, ease off and check in with your doctor.

Days 61–90 • Identity

Become the bloke who just does this. We stop "trying" and start being.

61–90

PHASE 3

Identity

FOCUS: THIS IS JUST WHO YOU ARE NOW

● ● ● PHASE 3 OF 3

The final stretch isn't about doing more — it's about owning it. You're no longer a tired dad attempting a reset. You're an active dad who moves, sleeps well and keeps his word to himself. These habits lock that identity in so it outlasts the 90 days.

↪ **Carry forward:** everything from Phases 1 & 2 — now it's just normal



Don't break the chain

The streak is the prize now. Show up even on the small days — a 5-minute walk still counts. Keep the chain alive.



"I am" language

Stop saying "I'm trying to get fit." Say "I'm a dad who moves every day." You become what you repeat.



Pick your own next step

Choose one thing that excites you — a longer run, a sport, lifting, a parkrun with the kids. Make it yours. (See *safety note*.)



Bring them with you

Walk with your kids. Let them see it. The real win isn't your weight — it's the example you're setting.

Move-safe note: Before stepping up to running, sport or lifting, clear it with your doctor and build gradually. New aches that linger, sharp pain or dizziness mean stop and get checked.

The core habits, explained simply

Six levers run this whole reset. None of them are complicated. Here's the why and the where-to-start for each.



Habit 01

Daily movement — start with a walk

Movement is the keystone that holds the rest up. It lifts your mood, burns off the stress, helps you sleep and quietly changes your body. You don't need a gym or a plan — you need to put your shoes on and go outside. A walk is the most underrated exercise there is, and it's the one you'll actually keep doing.

Start here: 10 minutes today. Same time each day if you can — after dinner is a good anchor. Build slowly from there, and read the move-safe notes first.



Habit 02

Sleep as the priority, not the leftover

You can't rebuild on no sleep. Tired dads reach for sugar, snap more, and quit faster. Sleep is when your body actually repairs and your head resets — it's not lazy, it's maintenance. Most of your energy problem starts here, so we fix it first and protect it hard.

Start here: Pick one fixed lights-out time and guard it like an appointment. In Phase 2 you add a screens-down hour before bed to make that sleep deeper.



Habit 03

Hydration — the easiest win you're missing

Half of "I'm exhausted" is often "I'm dehydrated." It's the simplest lever in the whole book — no cost, no effort, instant. Water before coffee sets the tone for a day where you're looking after yourself, not just getting through it.

Start here: One big glass of water before your first coffee, every morning. Keep a bottle where you'll see it.



Habit 04

Sunlight & a morning routine

Daylight early in the day sets your body clock — it sharpens your mornings and helps you wind down at night. Pairing it with a simple, repeatable morning (water, light, a short walk) means you start the day in control instead of already behind.

Start here: Get outside within an hour of waking, even for a few minutes. Combine it with your walk and your water and you've stacked three habits into one.



Habit 05

Mindset & self-talk

The voice in your head can be your worst coach. "I always quit," "I'm too far gone," "what's the point." That voice kept me stuck for years. You don't have to believe every thought you have — you can answer it. Talk to yourself the way you'd talk to your mate, or your son.

Start here: When the harsh line shows up, swap it for one honest, kinder one: "I'm a dad who's rebuilding, one day at a time." Say it even if you don't fully feel it yet.



Habit 06

Momentum — don't break the chain

Motivation comes and goes; the chain is what carries you. Every day you tick the box, you add a link, and the longer the chain the less you want to snap it. This is the engine of the whole 90 days. You're not trying to be perfect — you're trying not to miss twice in a row.

Start here: Use the weekly tracker below. Tick every habit you hit. On a hard day, do the tiniest version and still tick it — keeping the chain alive beats doing it "properly" and quitting.

Your weekly tracker

Print one copy per week. Tick a box for every habit you hit. Don't break the chain. (Hit "Save as PDF" up top to print a clean, ink-light copy.)

Week of _____ · Phase: Foundations / Momentum / Identity (circle one)

DAILY HABIT	MON	TUE	WED	THU	FRI	SAT	SUN
 Daily walk / movement	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
 Slept by my bedtime	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
 Water before coffee	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
 Morning light / routine	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
 One kind line to myself	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
 Chain unbroken	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐

Day count this week (0–7): _____ Best win of the week: _____

NOTES — HOW I FELT, WHAT GOT IN THE WAY

You **will** slip. Here's the rule.

Missing a day isn't failure — it's normal. What matters is the one move you make next. This is the part that decides whether you finish.

The skip-rule

Never miss twice in a row.

One missed day is a blip. Two in a row is how a blip becomes a quit. Make tomorrow non-negotiable, even if it's the tiniest version.

Don't double up

No "making it up."

Missed yesterday's walk? You don't owe two walks today. There's no debt to repay. Just do today's. Doubling up is a trap that leads to burnout.

Just restart

Pick up exactly where you are.

No guilt spiral, no "I've ruined it." You haven't. One missed tick doesn't erase the chain behind it. Tick today's box and carry on.

Shrink it

On a bad day, go tiny.

Can't face 30 minutes? Walk to the end of the street. Five minutes still counts. A tick on a hard day is worth more than a perfect day you skipped.

Remember: Restarting isn't starting over. Every day you've already done is still in the bank. The only way to truly fail this is to stop — so don't.

NINETY DAYS FROM NOW, YOU'LL BE A DIFFERENT DAD — AND IT STARTS WITH ONE WALK TODAY.

I'm proof it's not too late, and you don't have to do it perfectly — you just have to do it. Your kids don't need a perfect dad. They need a present one, here for the long haul. Print your tracker, take the walk, tick the box. Day one starts now.

HEAR THE STORY

The Dad's Code Podcast

The honest version of how I rebuilt my energy, body and head at 48 — the real conversations behind this reset, in your ears on the daily walk.

[Listen to Dad's Code →](#)

FUEL THE REBUILD

Dad Fuel

The companion guide: high-protein, no-fuss meals to power your 90 days, so you're never running on coffee and stress.

[Get Dad Fuel →](#)

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